



## Johnson Controls Tuition Reimbursement Program Employee User Guide

|                                                                          |   |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|
| Program Overview and Frequently Asked Questions .....                    | 2 |
| <b>Who is eligible to apply?</b> .....                                   | 2 |
| <b>What programs are eligible for tuition reimbursement?</b> .....       | 2 |
| <b>JCI Tuition Reimbursement Policy</b> .....                            | 3 |
| The Field of Study and Review Process.....                               | 4 |
| Step 1: Request Course Approval.....                                     | 4 |
| Step 2: Manager Review .....                                             | 4 |
| Step 3: Request Reimbursement .....                                      | 4 |
| The Application and Review Process .....                                 | 5 |
| <b>Who should I contact with any questions about this process?</b> ..... | 5 |
| Step-by-Step Application Instructions .....                              | 6 |





## Program Overview and Frequently Asked Questions

---

### Who is eligible to apply?

- The requesting employee's most recent performance rating on record must be at 'Meets' or higher for both the performance and behavior ratings.
- An employee is not eligible for consideration under this policy if he/she is the subject of a written improvement plan for below standard performance or has received a written warning for corrective action within the 6 months prior to the request.
- Must be an active employee at the time the course(s) begins and is completed.
- To participate in the Johnson Controls Tuition Reimbursement Program, employees must have completed twelve months of continuous service prior to the course start date.
- The employee's participation in the program must not negatively impact the employee's job performance.

### What programs are eligible for tuition reimbursement?

Johnson Controls Tuition Reimbursement Program provides eligible employees with reimbursement for courses that are part of an approved degree program (e.g., Associates, Bachelors, or Graduate degree) and offered by an accredited U.S. institution.

The following describes Course Eligibility:

- A college credit course related to the employee's current job OR to a job to which the employee could aspire
- A degree program in an area related to the employee's current job or as part of a career development program defined by the employee and the employee's manager.
- Degrees specifically not covered include, but are not limited to, medical, nursing, aviation, culinary arts, law, criminal justice, elementary education, and interior decorating.
- Foreign languages are not covered unless part of a requirement in pursuant of a degree.
- Distance learning, accelerated programs or courses that do not require scheduled attendance in traditional classrooms as part of the normal course of study, are eligible if they meet the criteria included in the Johnson Controls Tuition Reimbursement policy.

*Contact the HR Shared Service Center for support if you have questions on whether your institution is accredited according to these guidelines or if you are unsure about a particular degree program.*





## JCI Tuition Reimbursement Policy

- **Undergraduate** courses are limited to whichever is met first: **\$5,250 per calendar year or 20 credit hours**
- **Graduate** courses are limited to whichever is met first: **\$12,000 per calendar year or 20 credit hours**
  - Graduate level courses qualify for inclusion as part of a 'qualified tuition reimbursement program' as defined by the Internal Revenue service and shall qualify for exclusion from the employee's gross income subject to that annual \$5,250 limitation.
  - Any amounts reimbursed in excess of the annual \$5,250 limitation are fully taxable as income to the employee.
- Accelerated Programs (excluding Executive MBA programs):
  - Are eligible under this program
  - Are subject to the limitations stated above.
  - Accelerated Programs are still subject to the dollar limit and credit limit as stated above.
- Credits apply to the calendar year in which the course finished. The dollar limit applies to the year the course was reimbursed. Check with your Tuition Administration Administrator to see how this affects you.

*\*Note\* It is the employee's responsibility to obtain all required approvals **prior** to the start of classes. After an approved class has ended, employees must complete a Reimbursement Request Application within 60 days of course completion to receive tuition reimbursement.*





## The Field of Study and Review Process

---

Each employee will complete a Field of Study upon entry to the program. Once the Field of Study has been submitted, the employee's direct manager will receive a notification from ISTS with instructions for completing the form.

Employees will receive notification from ISTS with the status of their Field of Study. Upon approval, employees will be able to submit course approval to their direct manager.

### Step 1: Request Course Approval

Each employee will request their coursework via the Johnson Controls Tuition Reimbursement Program. Requests should be made before the beginning of the course start date. Eligible courses must start after twelve months of the employee's continuous service with the company.

### Step 2: Manager Review

### Step 3: Request Reimbursement

After your manager has submitted an approved review of your courses, you will receive notification of their decision. If you have been approved, you can request reimbursement after their courses have ended.





## The Application and Review Process

---

After an employee has completed and been approved for a Field of Study, the next step is to request Manager Approval for individual coursework. Each requested Course Approval form must be approved by the employee's direct manager and second level manager.

### **Who should I contact with any questions about this process?**

Any questions you or your employee have regarding the application process or JCI Tuition Reimbursement policy should be directed to ISTS via email at [JCITR@applyISTS.com](mailto:JCITR@applyISTS.com). ISTS office hours are Monday through Friday from 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM Central.





## Step-by-Step Application Instructions

---

1. The employee can access the application form at <https://aim.applyists.net/JCIFOSA>. The Employee may have to create an account if they are using the benefit for the first time.
2. Upon entering the application platform, the employee will enter their Employee ID and Last Name. Eligibility is automatically checked against our records.
3. Once the eligibility check has been met, applicants will submit a Field of Study Approval form. The approval will automatically be sent to the first-level manager to either approve or deny.
4. Once the student has approval, they can access the Tuition Reimbursement Hub link on their homepage at <https://aim.applyists.net>.
5. The employee will select *File a Course Approval* from the dropdown.
6. The applicant will fill out and submit the Course Approval application for any courses they have not yet started.
7. Upon submitting the Course Approval form, the form will be sent to the manager's account. If an account does not exist for the manager, one will be created for him/her under their JCI email address.
8. Once the first-level manager review has been completed, a second-level manager review will need to be completed. Every approved course will be sent to the second-level manager.
9. Upon receiving approval for their courses, the applicant may now take the courses.
10. Once the employee has finished the courses and received both a transcript and has a paid tuition bill, they will go back to the Tuition Reimbursement Hub at <https://aim.applyists.net>. This must be done within 60 days of completing the course.
11. The employee will choose *Apply for Reimbursement* from the dropdown.
12. The employee will select courses that appear in the table that they wish to receive reimbursement for.
13. Upon submitting this page, the applicant will be taken to the Reimbursement Request form to fill out the required information and provide the necessary documents.
14. Once submitted, the documents will be reviewed by the ISTS processing team and total payment processed. The applicant can check their home page at <https://aim.applyists.net> for updates for their most recent Reimbursement Request. They should receive notification if the reimbursement was approved, denied, or if ISTS needs the applicant to submit new documents.